

YUCHEN FENG

DEAN'S MEDAL NOMINEE 2026

Interdisciplinary designer and researcher integrating human-centered design, computational rigor, and applied innovation to address complex real-world challenges through research-informed systems and community-centered solutions.

CONTACT

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EDUCATION

University of Washington 2022–2026
B.S. in Human-Centered Design & Engineering, with minor in Neural Computation & Engineering, GPA: **3.94/4.00** (Credits Earned: 222)
· Dean's List for All Eligible Quarters & Years (2022–2025)

SKILLS

Design & Research Methodologies

mixed-methods research, usability testing, A/B testing, wire-framing, interaction design, information architecture, prototyping, storyboarding, design systems

Visualization & Design Tools

Figma, Figma Make, Adobe Creative Suite (InDesign, Photoshop), Miro, Canva, Procreate, Nano banana

Computational Systems

Python, Java, SQL, R, MATLAB, HTML, Arduino, Tableau, database systems, machine learning foundations

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

Product Manager & UX Researcher Jan–Jun 2025

Cornell Lab of Ornithology & UW Ecofutures Lab

- Led research and product direction for a multi-stakeholder redesign of Merlin Bird ID, identifying key barriers to novice retention and translating insights into actionable strategies.
- Executed comprehensive mixed-methods research and synthesized findings into prioritized product recommendations adopted in final design proposals.
- Presented strategic outcomes to 100+ stakeholders at the UW Capstone Showcase.

Product Design Lead Mar–Jun 2025

University of Washington, Neural Computation & Engineering

- Contributed to hardware research and assembly for a wearable foot-metrics system while designing the complete companion app prototype from concept to interface.
- Led research synthesis and team feedback integration, aligning technical constraints, user needs, and own design system.

Product Designer & Researcher Dec 2023–May 2024

University of Washington, Human-Centered Design & Engineering

- Originated and designed the full rule system and gameplay mechanics for an educational card game translating teamwork theory into interactive learning.
- Created all card content from course material, validating and refining the system through iterative testing with 60+ users.

COURSEWORKS

HCDE 308

*Advanced Visual
Communication & Figma
Systems*

HCDE 318

*User-centered Design
Methodologies*

HCDE 411

*Interactive data visualization
(Tableau, Altair)*

HCDE 439

*Physical Prototyping &
Interaction Design*

HCDE 498

Entrepreneurship in HCDE

BIOEN 466

*Neural signal processing and
closed-loop systems.*

CSE 416

Machine Learning

CSE 414

*Relational database systems,
SQL, and data modeling.*

Phil 442

*Neuroethics and analytical
writing.*

INNOVATION & APPLIED EXPERIENCE

Founding Product Designer*Aug 2025–present*

Pairst Technology Inc. (Early-Stage Startup)

- Built a networking app from 0→1 in a startup environment, defining product direction, core value proposition, and end-to-end user experience from concept to beta launch.
- Established the full brand and design system, including logo, color architecture, typography, and motion assets to ensure a cohesive product identity.
- Designed and iterated key growth and engagement flows (onboarding, referral, premium features), integrating continuous user feedback and supporting launch with 100+ waitlist users and 50+ beta testers.

CO-founder & CTO*Nov 2025–present*

Ikigai Creativity (Early-Stage Startup)

- Co-founded a travel-inspired craft subscription startup, leading technical strategy, brand development, and product direction from concept through business plan completion.
- Developed and iterated a demo physical craft box prototype, incorporating user insights gathered from 100+ entrepreneurs at a pop-up market and expanding early community engagement.

Experience Designer*Oct 2023–Mar 2025*

Seattle Sichuan Hotpot

- Managed day-to-day restaurant operations, serving as primary liaison between staff and customers in a cross-cultural environment.
- Collaborated directly with the owner to redesign the menu, instructional eating guide and internal design, improving clarity for Chinese hotpot diners and enhancing overall user experience.

AWARDS

Academic

*YuanPei Young Scholar at
Peking University (2022)*

*LMI Leadership Certification –
“Attitude Is Everything” (2022)*

Art & Music

*National Professional Level
Certification of Chinese
Calligraphy (Major Level)*

ABRSM Grade 5 Music Theory

*Shanghai Conservatory of
Music, Piano Grade 10*

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Vice President*Seattle, present*

UW WeGet Magazine (Led visual direction; organized campus-wide events)

UW Han Chinese Culture Club (Organized campus cultural events)

Teaching Assistant*China, 2023*

'Attitude is Everything' Leadership Program (LMI Certified Facilitator)

Volunteer*China & Remote, 2020–2023*

*Drama Therapy Program for Autistic Children (Designed in-person and
remote engagement activities)*

Freelance Calligrapher & Designer*China & Seattle, present*

Fresh Inc. at Shanghai IFC Mall (Customized designs for in-store events)

UW Maker Fair Vendor (Individual business on creative design products)